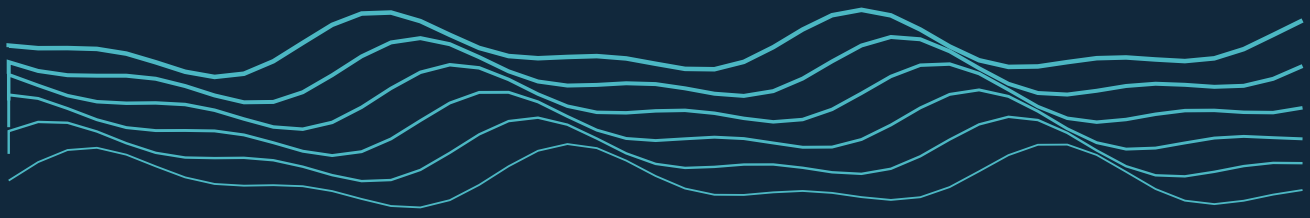
STEP-BY-STEP WINDOWS GUIDE

LRC BULK FINDER

COMPLETE USER MANUAL

Version 2.4.3



From the first download to your first synchronized lyrics,
full-library searches, candidate review and troubleshooting.

CREATED BY DIMITRIS L.

Public Beta | Windows | October 2026

START HERE

This manual is written for someone who has never used LRC Bulk Finder before. Follow the steps in order for your first successful search; return to the later sections when you need advanced settings or extra tools.

What LRC Bulk Finder does

It reads your music files, searches for synchronized lyrics, and saves a separate **.lrc** text file beside each song. It does **not** rename music, change sound, edit tags, or overwrite an existing .lrc. Some lyrics are uncertain and are saved for review.

Your shortest route to a first search

01 **Download the correct ZIP**

Choose the standalone Windows EXE if you do not want to install Python. Choose the complete Python/CMD package if you also want optional local Greek AI.

02 **Extract the entire ZIP**

Do not double-click the program while it is still inside the compressed ZIP archive.

03 **Open the Control Center**

Run **LRC_Control_Center.exe** (standalone) or **OPEN_CONTROL_CENTER.cmd** (Python package).

04 **Choose a folder and search mode**

Select the music folder. If you have the large local LRCLIB SQLite database, point the program to it; otherwise choose normal Search action 1.

05 **Test with 20 songs**

Use **20**, save your profile, click **Save profile and START SEARCH**, then inspect the new .lrc files and review candidates.

Important distinction

Search action 5 requires the large LRCLIB local database. If you do not have it, choose **Search action 1** for an online search. You do not need the huge database just to try the program.

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Each chapter is self-contained, but the recommended order for a new user is: install → choose a library → search 20 songs → inspect results → expand to the full folder.

01 What the program creates

An LRC file is a small text file containing lyric lines and timestamps. Compatible players display the corresponding words as the song progresses.

Simple example

```
Music\Song Name.mp3
Music\Song Name.lrc
```

The two files must have the **same base name** and be in the **same folder**. The audio file remains unchanged. For other supported formats, the naming principle is the same: **Song Name.flac** pairs with **Song Name.lrc**.

What a synchronized lyric file looks like

```
[00:12.40] First line of the song
[00:17.25] Second line of the song
[00:21.90] Third line of the song
```

Numbers in brackets represent minutes, seconds and fractions of a second. The car radio or music player must specifically support synchronized LRC files for timed display. Some players support only basic LRC.

Verified matches versus review candidates

.lrc	Usually passed strict checks; a manually promoted candidate stays marked	Try playing the song and confirm the timing on your device.
.candidate.lrc	Possible match, not automatically accepted	Review the text and recording before installing it.
.candidate.2.lrc etc.	Additional alternatives for the same song	Keep them for review; not automatically installed.

Safety promise

The program writes sidecar lyrics and reports. It does not change original audio, audio tags or an already-existing .lrc file. Automatic acceptance checks artist/title identity, recording version and a duration gap of at most about 3 seconds. It skips conflicting stems such as Song.mp3 and Song.flac in the same directory.

02 Before you download

Supported audio files

MP3, FLAC, M4A, MP4, OGG, OPUS and WAV can be read where their tags and duration are available to the program. For best matching, each file should have a usable title, artist and duration. Original or corrected music tags are read, not edited.

Choose one of two Windows editions

Best for	Most beginners; install-free core app	Users who want console tools or local Greek AI
Launch	**LRC_Control_Center.exe**	**OPEN_CONTROL_CENTER.cmd**
Python installed?	Not required for normal features	Python 3.10+ required
Local Greek AI?	Not included	Optional, separately installed
Search engine	Companion worker EXE included	Python search engine included
Offline database	External, optional for action 1, required for 4/5	Same

Official download page

github.com/DimitrisLai/LRC-Bulk-Finder/releases/tag/v2.4.3

On the release page, choose **LRC_Bulk_Finder_v2_4_3_Standalone_Windows_GUI.zip** or **LRC_Bulk_Finder_Public_v2_4_3_GitHub_Release_Windows.zip**. Do not choose the generic GitHub “Source code” ZIP when you expect all launchers and bundled resources.

Windows security notice

The optional standalone EXEs are unsigned Public Beta builds. A Windows SmartScreen warning does not prove malware, but the warning must be taken seriously. Verify the official release source and file hash, scan with your security software, and follow your organization’s policy. Do not switch off Defender or SmartScreen globally.

03 Install and open the standalone application

This is the simplest route for most Windows users. No separate Python installation is needed for normal searches.

01 **Download the standalone ZIP**

From the official v2.4.3 release page, download **LRC_Bulk_Finder_v2_4_3_Standalone_Windows_GUI.zip**.

02 **Extract all files**

In Windows File Explorer, right-click the ZIP and choose **Extract All...**. Pick a normal writable folder, for example **Documents\LRC Bulk Finder**. Avoid Program Files if your account cannot write there.

03 **Keep the files together**

The folder must contain **LRC_Control_Center.exe** and **LRC_Bulk_Finder_Worker.exe**, plus the supplied dictionary, contact and resource files. Do not drag only the first EXE to the desktop.

04 **Open the app**

Double-click **LRC_Control_Center.exe**. You should see a window titled **LRC Bulk Finder v2.4.3 — Control Center**.

05 **Choose the right search mode**

If you do **not** have a large LRCLIB SQLite snapshot, choose Search action **1** before starting. If you already have the snapshot, see chapter 5 to attach it.

> **If nothing opens**
>
> Make sure you extracted the full ZIP, the worker EXE is beside the GUI, and Windows security software has not quarantined a file. Do not run the program straight from within ZIP preview. See the Troubleshooting chapter.

Where your settings go

Profiles are saved separately in your Windows user account at **%APPDATA%\LRCBulkFinder\profiles.json**. Your songs stay wherever you placed them; profiles are not stored inside your MP3 tags.

04 Install and open the Python/CMD edition

Use this edition for the classic five-option console, the built-in launchers, or the optional downloaded Greeklish-to-Greek AI model.

01 **Download the complete Windows ZIP**

Download **LRC_Bulk_Finder_Public_v2_4_3_GitHub_Release_Windows.zip** from the official v2.4.3 release and extract its entire contents into a folder.

02 **Check your Python version**

Install **Python 3.10 or later** from python.org/downloads if needed. The launchers check for a compatible interpreter. In PowerShell, **py --version** can help confirm what is installed.

03

Run the GUI launcher

Double-click **OPEN_CONTROL_CENTER.cmd**. It checks required packages (**mutagen**, **Unidecode**, **syncedlyrics**) and attempts to install missing dependencies using pip.

04

Allow the package check to finish

A command window may appear while dependencies are checked or installed. Once complete, the Control Center GUI should open. An internet connection may be needed for the initial Python package installation.

05

Use the console only if you prefer it

Double-click **START_HERE.cmd** for the interactive five-action text menu. GUI and console share the same core search logic; see chapter 17 for every menu mode.

Do not confuse these launchers

OPEN_CONTROL_CENTER.cmd opens the graphical interface. **START_HERE.cmd** opens the console menu. **Run_Diagnostics.cmd** checks your Python environment if a launcher fails.

05 Connect the offline LRCLIB database

LRCLIB is a large catalogue of time-synchronized lyrics. The application can search a locally stored SQLite snapshot without internet access. The database is not inside either ZIP.

A. I already have the database (recommended if available)

01 **Locate the extracted database**

Find the actual **.sqlite3** or compatible SQLite database file on your disk. This is usually a very large file, not the smaller **Greek_Lexicon.sqlite3** word dictionary.

02 **Choose it from the GUI**

Open **Saved searches** and click **Choose database** next to **Existing local LRCLIB SQLite**. Select the file and save the profile.

03 **Or connect it from the Python edition**

Double-click **CONNECT_EXISTING_LRCLIB_DATABASE.cmd**, select or paste the extracted SQLite path, and confirm. The app records it in **LRCLIB_LOCAL_DB.txt**; it does not copy the huge file.

04 **Try a small offline test**

Select **Greek OFFLINE ONLY** if appropriate, set the number of songs to **20**, and run the scan. A completed offline-only scan performs no web searches.

B. I do not have a database

You have two reasonable choices:

- **Start online:** select Search action **1**. This is sufficient for trying the application and does not require the huge snapshot.
- **Download the large snapshot:** in the GUI click **Download / set up LRCLIB database**, then carefully follow the separate installer's questions.

C. Download the full snapshot (advanced; very large)

01 **Open the optional installer**

Use the GUI setup button or, in the Python package, **SETUP_LRCLIB_DATABASE.cmd**. It does not start automatically.

02 **Consent to discovering and downloading a snapshot**

The installer asks whether to find the newest published dump and whether to continue with the large download. Read the displayed size and source before answering Y.

03 **Choose a drive with substantial free space**

The installer requires at least **350 GiB of free space** on the selected drive as its preflight minimum. Some snapshots have exceeded 240 GiB extracted; sizes can change.

04 **Allow download, extraction and validation**

The installer can resume partial downloads when applicable and validates the SQLite file. Keep the computer powered on and storage connected.

05

Select the installed database in your profile

Return to **Saved searches** and use **Choose database**. The source file is reused; it is not embedded inside the program.

Storage caution

Do not download another enormous snapshot if you already have a valid one. Do not run **CLEANUP_LRCLIB_DATABASE.cmd** casually: that utility can remove the downloaded compressed archive, the extracted SQLite database, or both.

06 Get to know the Control Center

The Control Center has five tabs. Most beginners will spend their time in Saved searches, Live progress and Candidate review.

Saved searches	Choose folder, database, preset, options and profiles	Preset dropdown, folder selectors, provider options, checkboxes and Start button
Live progress	Follow an active search and stop it	Progress bar, per-stage ETA, six counters, STOP/Resume buttons and log
Candidate review	Read uncertain lyrics and promote a selected candidate	Candidate table, read-only lyric preview, external Play and Promote buttons
Sync Lab (experimental)	Make a draft from your own untimed lyrics	Audio picker, import/paste, estimated timestamps or manual taps, unverified save

The correct daily routine

Saved searches → choose or adjust a profile → **Save profile and START SEARCH** → watch **Live progress** → inspect created files → open **Candidate review** for uncertain lyrics.

The program remembers profiles in your Windows user account. It does not automatically start an overnight profile on a schedule. Night Search means that profile is configured for a long unattended run *after you launch it*.

07 Your first search: step-by-step

This walkthrough intentionally limits the first run to 20 eligible tracks. It is the safest way to confirm that your files, the program and your chosen sources work together.

01

Open the Control Center

Choose the **Saved searches** tab. The same tab is used in both Windows editions.

02 **Choose the music folder**

Click **Browse...** alongside **MP3 folder** and select a folder with your songs. The label says MP3 folder, but all seven supported formats can be scanned. If your songs are in subfolders, leave **Include subfolders** checked.

03 **Decide whether you have the large database**

If yes, click **Choose database** and select the SQLite file. If not, choose **Search action 1** rather than action 5 or 4.

04 **Choose the music language**

For a Greek/Greeklish collection, enable **Greeklish / Greek folder**. This adds search alternatives; it does not filter out non-Greek files. Keep **Use installed local Greek AI** off unless you installed it and use the Python edition.

05 **Set a small test**

Enter **20** in **Number of songs**. Select **full** if you want maximum provider coverage, or **fast** for fewer routes.

06 **Start with simple provider settings**

Choose **d** (DEFAULT) in **Provider order**. Keep **MusicBrainz variants** if your tags may need assistance. Keep **Search after Greek preview** checked if you want the search to continue after the preview.

07 **Name and start the profile**

Enter a clear **Saved profile** name, for example **My First 20 Songs**, then click **Save profile and START SEARCH**. The program saves the settings and automatically opens **Live progress**.

08 **Inspect the output**

After completion, open the music folder and look for new **.lrc** files and any **.candidate.lrc** files. See the results and candidate-review chapters for the output.

New users without the SQLite dump

For an international or Greek folder with no large local database, a good first test is: **Action 1 / FULL / DEFAULT / 20 songs**. If you already have the database, the **Greek Quick Test — 20 Songs** preset uses action 5 and searches offline first.

08 Choose a preset

Presets fill in a group of settings. They are not locked: you can adjust any field, choose your own name and save a profile.

Greek FULL — Offline First	Usual full Greek collection; local DB first, then all online routes and timed-out requests	Requires local LRCLIB SQLite

Greek Night Search — Maximum Coverage	Long unattended search with provider-recovery waiting	Requires local DB and a computer that stays on
Greek Quick Test — 20 Songs	Check a Greek folder on 20 eligible songs	Requires local DB
Greek OFFLINE ONLY	No online lyric/metadata queries; local SQLite only	Requires local DB
Greek Local AI — FULL	Offline-first plus optional local G2G language model	Requires local DB and the Python AI installation
International FAST — 20 Songs	Short non-Greek online search using five providers	No large DB required

Apply a preset correctly

01 **Select the preset**

Use the **Ready-made preset** dropdown at the top of **Saved searches**.

02 **Click Apply preset**

The settings change to the preset’s values. Your existing folder and database fields are preserved.

03 **Check the fields**

Make sure the folder exists, the database requirement is satisfied, and the song limit is what you want.

04 **Save under your own name**

Change the **Saved profile** name if you want a personal version rather than reusing the built-in preset name. Then click **Save** or **Save profile and START SEARCH**.

> **Night Search is not a scheduler**
>
> It changes the recovery and search settings but does not automatically launch at midnight or any other time. You must start it, keep Windows awake, and allow enough time for rate-limited providers.

09 Every setting explained

You can use presets and skip advanced fields at first. This reference explains every control in the Saved searches tab.

Saved profile	A local name for your folder and settings	A recognizable name
MP3 folder	Folder containing audio; all supported formats can be read	Browse to test folder
Existing local LRCLIB SQLite	Path to the big offline snapshot	Select if available
Search action 5 / 1 / 4	Staged offline-first / normal search / fully offline	1 without DB; 5 with DB
Provider mode fast / full	Five provider routes / all twelve routes	full for best coverage
Provider order d / s / c	Default / smart statistics / custom exact order	d
CUSTOM order	Comma-separated order of every selected provider	Leave blank unless c
Number of songs	How many eligible missing songs to process	20 then A

Checkboxes and toggles

Greeklish / Greek folder	Adds reviewed Greek/Greeklish title and artist alternatives; not a language filter.
Use installed local Greek AI	Uses the optional separately downloaded G2G model; requires Python installation.
MusicBrainz variants	Queries extra artist/title metadata; often helpful, but slower.
Include subfolders	Scans the selected folder and nested directories.
Wait for unavailable providers	Waits for temporarily unavailable routes before first attempts; potentially very slow.
Use cached completed NO_MATCH history	Avoids repeating recent definite failed queries; disable for a deliberate fresh test.
Extra LRCLIB exact-signature request	Tries an additional exact online LRCLIB lookup; adds requests.
Search after Greek preview	Continues automatically after preview preparation; otherwise stops at preview.
Incremental library tracking	Caches local read-only metadata to speed repeat scans.

EXPERIMENTAL SimpMusic (FULL mode only)	An optional extra source trial, disabled by default. It is not part of beginner presets; results still require the strict identity and recording-duration checks.

> **CUSTOM provider order has a rule**
>
> If you select **c** for custom order, list **every** selected provider exactly once, separated by commas. A partial list is not valid. The standard preset uses DEFAULT and needs no custom text.

10 What happens during a search

Search action 5 is the most complete offline-first workflow when the large SQLite database is available.

The three stages of Action 5

1 - Offline	Searches the local LRCLIB database for every eligible missing track in the selected batch.	No
2 - Online	For songs still lacking an approved .lrc, searches enabled online provider routes.	Yes
3 - Timeout retry	Retries only the exact provider/song pairs that actually timed out in stage 2.	Yes

The program does not interpret every “not found,” 429/503 error or unavailable provider as a timeout. Retry behavior is intentionally conservative. Some routes may be unavailable due to remote service restrictions or throttling.

Normal search and offline-only alternatives

- **Action 1:** a normal search that can use a configured local SQLite database before online sources for an individual song; no large local database is mandatory.
- **Action 4:** searches the local SQLite snapshot only, sends no web lyrics or MusicBrainz requests, and writes separate offline reports.

Tracks the program skips

- Files already accompanied by a same-stem **.lrc**.
- Tracks recognized as **LIVE** in the filename or title tag (per matching rules).
- Tracks with colliding same-stem audio formats in the same folder, such as **Song.mp3** plus **Song.flac**.

No result is guaranteed for every song, especially rare remixes, instrumental recordings, radio versions and songs missing from accessible catalogues.

11 Understand the Live progress screen

The **Live progress** tab shows the current round, a progress bar, the current-round estimate, six numeric counters and a scrollable log.

The six counters

THIS STAGE	Songs / LRC found	Different songs given a verified .lrc in the current stage.
THIS STAGE	Songs / Candidate found	Different songs with actual review candidate files saved in this stage.
THIS STAGE	Not found	Completed searches without an accepted LRC or candidate; network errors/timeouts do not count.
THIS STAGE	Skipped / no metadata	Audio lacking usable artist/title metadata; not an actual lyric search miss.
ALL STAGES	LRC Count	Unique songs for which verified .lrc was saved during this run.
ALL STAGES	Candidate Count	Unique songs that received a saved candidate during this run.

The first four values return to zero at the beginning/end of completed stage changes; the last two remain cumulative for that run. Even three candidate files for one song count as **one candidate song**. If a song first receives a candidate and later gets a verified LRC, it may appear in both historical totals.

Example

> ### After Stage 1
>
> Stage 1 saved 10 verified lyrics and candidates for 5 different songs. As Stage 2 begins, the four THIS STAGE counters are 0; **LRC Count** stays 10 and **Candidate Count** stays 5.

Progress and ETA

The ETA is an estimate for **THIS ROUND**, not for all three stages combined. It begins after enough new song samples (normally three). Cached and resumed entries do not provide fresh speed measurements. Overnight routes can make the estimate change significantly.

Log buttons

Clear displayed log removes only the current on-screen text. It does not delete audio, already created LRC files or the search results saved to the folder. **Resume previous search** can restart the last recorded unfinished saved profile after you confirm.

12 Stop a search and resume safely

You can stop an active GUI search without closing the Control Center.

01 **Open Live progress**

Find the button labeled **STOP SEARCH — keep app open**.

02 **Click STOP**

A confirmation window warns that the search worker will be terminated immediately.

03 **Confirm only if you want to stop**

When confirmed, the application terminates the search worker process tree. The graphical Control Center remains open. Canceling the confirmation continues the search.

04 **Allow the status to update**

Previously completed, flushed checkpoint entries remain. The active unfinished song and not-yet-written final reports might be incomplete.

05 **Use the Resume previous search button**

After the worker stops, click **Resume previous search** in Live progress. Review the saved profile and directory shown in the confirmation, then confirm. The same existing checkpoint logic replays completed unchanged work and retries unfinished files. You can alternatively start the same profile from Saved searches.

Important: STOP is a hard stop

This is not a graceful finish-and-write-reports action. If the app reports STOP NOT FULLY VERIFIED, a child process may still be alive. Check Windows Task Manager and do not start another scan until the old worker and its children are gone. Completed checkpoints survive, but the current track or report may be incomplete.

Where checkpoints live

Per-song/stage search checkpoints are stored as a local JSONL file under the selected music folder. In v2.4.3 the versioned filename is based on the current version, for example **LRC_Run_Checkpoint_v2_4_3.jsonl**. Completed entries are reused only when relevant settings and tracked inputs are compatible.

When to start completely fresh

If you intentionally want to ignore previous stage checkpoints, make a backup and rename the applicable checkpoint file before starting. This can repeat provider requests. Existing approved .lrc files are still skipped.

13 Find your results and reports

Most results are written directly inside the selected music library. You do not have to export them from the program.

The files you are looking for

Song.lrc	A synchronized sidecar, normally automatic-verified; manually promoted candidates retain a visible unverified marker.
Song.candidate.lrc	An unverified synchronized lyric candidate that needs review.
Song.candidate.2.lrc	An additional unverified alternative.
LRC_Not_Found.txt	Songs with no accepted result from completed searches; some providers may have been unavailable.
LRC_Review_Needed.txt	Songs with uncertain results needing review.
LRC_Timeouts.txt	Unfinished requests, timeouts, server failures or deferred rate limits.
LRC_Skipped.txt	Files with no usable artist/title metadata, not genuine no-match searches.

Detailed CSV reports (normal or action 5 search)

LRC_Finder_Report_v2_1_15.csv	Track-by-track status, reason and provider outcomes.
LRC_Finder_Review_v2_1_15.csv	Uncertain candidates and why the match was not accepted automatically.
LRC_Finder_Provider_Details_v2_1_15.csv	Provider-by-provider request outcomes and elapsed times.
LRC_HTTP_Diagnostics_v2_1_15.csv	HTTP response/transport details where available.
LRC_Source_Statistics_v2_1_15.csv	Provider totals and aggregate outcomes.
LRC_First_Attempt_Coverage_v2_4_3.csv	Which source was contacted, skipped, unavailable or already covered.
LRC_Provider_Contribution_v2_4_3.csv	Distinct saved verified LRC files by actual provider (checkpointed past saves may be included).

Some report names retain historical compatible numbers. They are still written by the current program and do not mean an outdated executable was launched.

Greek preview, offline-only and backups

• **LRC_Greek_Search_Preview_v2_1_15.csv** and **LRC_G2G_AI_Review_v2_1_15.csv**: Greek search alternatives/previews when Greek mode is on.

• **LRC_Offline_Only_Report_v2_1_15.csv** and **LRC_Offline_Only_Review_v2_1_15.csv**: separate outputs from action 4.

• **LRC_Run_Reports\Run_..._v2_4_3**: time-stamped archive of available final reports after completed normal/staged runs.

If you pressed STOP before completion

A hard stop may happen before the final CSV and archive are written. Already saved .lrc files and completed checkpoints remain; start the same profile again to finish remaining work.

14 Review uncertain lyric candidates

Candidate files are saved because their text looks promising but does not meet the strict automatic acceptance criteria. A user must decide whether a candidate belongs to the correct recording.

01 **Open Candidate review**

When no search is active, go to the **Candidate review** tab and click **Refresh candidates**.

02 **Select a candidate**

The table shows the audio name, candidate filename and status. Select a row to display the synchronized text below.

03 **Play the corresponding audio**

Click **Play audio externally**. Windows opens the song using the default music player. Listen while reading the displayed lyric lines.

04 **Check song identity and timing**

Compare the artist, title, vocals, remix/live/studio version and approximate timestamps. The program cannot promise that a candidate is right.

05 **Promote only an eligible first candidate**

Choose a row marked **Primary — review**, then click **Promote selected to MARKED LRC** and confirm. The program will not promote an already-installed LRC, an ambiguous audio stem or a numbered candidate directly.

06 **Understand the marker**

The new .lrc begins with **[00:00.00] candidate**. It is still **UNVERIFIED** and should be checked in a player.

Approve a Greek or Greeklish spelling locally

01 **Review the artist or title**

If you see an incorrect Greeklish-to-Greek variant while reviewing, determine its correct Greek spelling yourself. Do not approve a guess.

02 **Click Approve Greek alias...**

In Candidate review, click **Approve Greek alias...**. Choose **artist** or **title**, then enter the exact Greeklish original and the reviewed Greek spelling.

03

Confirm the exact pair

Read the confirmation carefully. The app saves it locally to **Greek_Aliases.csv** and applies it to later searches. Audio tags are not changed. Conflicting aliases are rejected rather than silently replaced.

What happens to numbered alternatives?

```
Before: Song.mp3
        Song.candidate.lrc
        Song.candidate.2.lrc
        Song.candidate.3.lrc

After:  Song.mp3
        Song.lrc                (with candidate marker)
        Song.candidate.lrc
        Song.candidate.2.lrc
```

If the promoted lyrics are correct, you may manually remove only the **[00:00.00] candidate** marker from the .lrc using a plain-text editor. If wrong, delete the incorrect **Song.lrc** yourself before considering another candidate; the program will not overwrite it.

15 Use Sync Lab to create an unverified LRC draft

Sync Lab is useful when you already have untimed lyric text that you are allowed to use. It does not transcribe the song or automatically align syllables with the recording.

Method A - generate rough estimated timestamps

01 **Choose the track**

Open **Sync Lab (experimental)** and click **Choose audio...**. Select MP3, FLAC, M4A, MP4, OGG, OPUS or WAV.

02 **Paste or import text**

Paste lyrics into **Plain lyrics** or click **Import plain text...** to open a .txt or plain .lrc file. At least two actual lyric lines are needed.

03 **Click Generate ESTIMATED timestamps**

The program distributes approximate times across the track duration. It does not detect when the singer starts or stops.

04 **Edit the draft**

Check the displayed editable LRC line by line. Correct the timestamps yourself. Keep the candidate marker as the first line.

05 **Save an unverified candidate**

Click **Save as UNVERIFIED .candidate.lrc (never overwrite)** and confirm. The output is stored beside the audio file.

Method B - tap times manually while the audio plays

01 **Choose audio and prepare lyrics**

Pick the track, paste/import the text, and click **Open audio player**. The external player opens independently.

02 **Start tap timing**

Synchronize playback yourself and click **Start tap timing** at the start of the timing attempt.

03 **Tap for every lyric line**

Each time a lyric line begins in the audio, press **Tap NEXT line**. Repeat until every line has been marked.

04 **Review and save**

Read the generated text, adjust if necessary, then confirm **Save as UNVERIFIED .candidate.lrc**.

Limits and protection

Sync Lab requires complete estimates/taps before saving, protects existing .lrc files, and creates a numbered candidate rather than replacing an existing one. It is experimental timing assistance - not audio fingerprinting, transcription or verified automatic synchronization.

16 Greek and Greeklish search options

Greek mode is designed to help filenames and metadata that use Greek letters, Greeklish transliterations, accented spellings or common word variants.

How the program searches

The original artist and title remain primary. Additional approved Greek variants come from reviewed dictionaries and optional local G2G AI. The program does not rename the audio or automatically edit tags just because a title can be written in Greek.

Local dictionary files

- **Greek_Aliases.csv**: reviewed complete-title or artist aliases, including personal corrections you choose to maintain.
- **Greek_Artists.csv**: curated Greek artist/group names and spellings.
- **Greek_Words.csv** and **Greek_Words_Expanded.csv**: recognized Greeklish word spellings and their Greek alternatives.
- **Greek_Lexicon.sqlite3**: small optional local word lookup database. This is **not** the huge LRCLIB lyrics database.

Optional Greek G2G AI installation

01 **Use the Python/CMD edition**

The standalone EXE intentionally does not bundle the large Greek language model. Extract the complete Python edition first.

02 **Click Download / set up Greek G2G AI**

Or double-click **SETUP_GREEK_AI.cmd** from the extracted Python package. It asks for confirmation before downloading/installing the toolkit.

03 **Let the sample test complete**

The script installs **gr-nlp-toolkit** and initializes a local **g2g** model. The model and dependencies may require roughly 1.2 GB or more.

04 **Enable it in your profile**

Return to the Control Center and check both **Greeklish / Greek folder** and **Use installed local Greek AI**. Run a 20-song quality test first.

> **Human review is still needed**
>
> Greeklish-to-Greek conversion can be ambiguous. Names, remixes and lyrics can be misidentified. Use preview reports to inspect suggestions and correct your reviewed alias sources; do not assume the AI result proves a recording is identical.

17 Use the classic five-option console

This chapter is for the complete Python/CMD package. Open **START_HERE.cmd** to use the interactive menu instead of saved GUI profiles.

1 - SEARCH	Normal searching of a music folder, optional local DB first, then online providers	Yes
2 - INSTALL marked candidates	Bulk-promote primary review candidates with explicit confirmation	No
3 - LRCLIB-only catch-up	Revisit a previous run’s LRCLIB catch-up queue	Depends on chosen catch-up mode
4 - OFFLINE LRCLIB ONLY	Search any folder only against your local SQLite dump	No
5 - OFFLINE FIRST	Whole-folder local stage, online misses, timeout-only retry	Offline first; then yes

The full Option 5 prompt walkthrough

These settings are asked before the search begins. If you selected a folder using the Windows chooser, that is a separate dialog step. Exact on-screen question wording may include bracketed default answers.

1	Choose main menu action	5
2	Select the music folder; if required, provide existing large SQLite path	Your test music folder + DB
3	Greeklish / Greek folder?	Y
4	Installed local G2G AI?	N, unless installed
5	MusicBrainz extra artist/title metadata?	Y, optional
6	FAST or FULL providers?	full
7	Provider order?	D (DEFAULT)
8	Wait for temporary provider recovery?	N for shorter test
9	Include subfolders?	Y

10	Skip recent cached NO_MATCH?	N for fresh test
11	How many missing songs?	20
12	LRCLIB exact-signature fallback?	Y if extra network calls acceptable
13	Search after Greek preview?	Y

If you choose **C** for custom provider order in step 7, the console asks one additional question for every selected provider name in the requested sequence. For **Option 1**, the same broad online preferences apply, but the large local SQLite database is not required.

Option 4: strictly offline

Choose 4 → music folder → existing local database if not configured → Greek mode → optional installed local AI → include subfolders → 20 or A → confirm **Start offline-only scan?** with Y. No MusicBrainz or online lyrics request is made by the offline scan.

Option 2: many candidates at once

Choose 2, select a music folder, decide whether to include subfolders, review the displayed primary-candidate list and explicitly confirm. Because this acts in bulk, first practise with a small copy of your music folder. The report is **LRC_Candidate_Promotion_Report_v2_1_16.csv**.

Option 3: LRCLIB catch-up

This is **not** the way to scan a brand-new folder. It is intended for a catch-up queue from an earlier search when some LRCLIB first attempts were skipped or unavailable. Use Option 4 for a new offline-only folder scan.

18 Providers and advanced search order

The program offers multiple synchronized-lyrics routes, some overlapping. The normal FULL list contains twelve routes; a thirteenth experimental SimpMusic route is opt-in and OFF by default.

FAST and FULL provider sets

FAST (5): LRCLIB, SyncLRC, NetEase, Unison, LrcAPI.

FULL (12): LRCLIB, SyncLRC, Unison, BetterKuGou, BetterTTML, YouLyTTML, LrcAPI, LiriQo, NetEase, Musixmatch, Megalobiz, Tencent.

Choose a search order

d - DEFAULT	Uses the standard ordering	First tests; easiest to compare
s - SMART	Uses prior measured verified-save performance and time; limited samples are treated cautiously	After enough real completed runs

c - CUSTOM	Uses exactly the comma-separated list you supply; must contain every provider in selected mode	Advanced benchmarking and experiments

What provider status messages mean

- **READY** means the route is configured, *not* that the remote server has been contacted successfully.
- **NO_MATCH** indicates a completed search without an acceptable result.
- **REVIEW** means a possible synchronized lyric was recorded but not accepted automatically.
- **TIMEOUT**, **SERVER_ERROR**, **DEFERRED_RATE_LIMIT** and unauthorized responses signal incomplete availability; they are not equivalent to a song lacking lyrics.

The app respects provider rate limits and may skip routes temporarily. Tencent’s optional library may not be present in all Python installations. Online services can change independently of LRC Bulk Finder.

19 Understand the Provider Health dashboard

This screen shows what the app actually observed during the current search. It is not an independent test of every lyrics service and does not contact providers by itself.

01 **Open Provider health**

Start or complete a search, then select **Provider health** at the top of the Control Center.

02 **Read Latest state**

Working, **Review**, **Timed out**, **Blocked** or **Recovering** describe recent observed outcomes. **Not contacted** means no evidence of availability.

03 **Check successful requests separately**

Latest HTTP 2xx means the route returned a successful HTTP response when visible. This does not prove the lyric belongs to your recording.

04 **Find genuinely installed LRCs**

Verified hits and **Last verified hit** update only when a verified .lrc has actually been written. A returned lyric that fails identity/version/duration checks stays a review candidate.

05 **See which source helped**

After a completed normal/staged search, open **LRC_Provider_Contribution_v2_4_3.csv** in your music folder. It lists distinct verified sidecars attributed to each saving provider. Previously checkpointed results may appear in the report.

> **Do not mistake an HTTP success for a safe music match**
>
> A provider can return HTTP 200 with empty, plain, duplicate or wrong-version lyrics. Only a validated write is counted as a verified install. Unofficial experimental sources may stop working at any time.

Optional SimpMusic experiment

The **EXPERIMENTAL SimpMusic (FULL mode only)** checkbox is OFF by default. Only enable it on a small test folder when you intentionally want to trial another provider. The endpoint may be unavailable, change format or omit resolved recording duration. Without trustworthy resolved identity, version and duration, its synchronized text is kept as an UNVERIFIED candidate, never auto-approved. Other experimental routes are research only; they are not active provider choices.

20 Safe library management and repeat scans

Incremental library tracking

When enabled, the GUI writes a local metadata index named **LRC_Incremental_Library_v2_4.sqlite3** in the selected music folder. It tracks file size, modification time, read-only metadata and whether the corresponding .lrc exists. It is mainly useful for repeated scans on a large collection.

New or changed audio files are scanned again. Incremental metadata tracking does **not** bypass lyric matching, overwrite sidecars or replace the resumable per-song search checkpoints. Turn it off if you want a complete metadata reread.

Same-stem collision example

```
MyMusic\Song.mp3
MyMusic\Song.flac
MyMusic\Song.lrc  <-- ambiguous: which audio version?
```

Files with the same stem but different audio extensions within one directory are skipped rather than both writing Song.lrc. Rename the audio versions to distinct stems if appropriate (manually, outside the application), then scan again.

Keep Windows and your storage ready

- Extract the application somewhere writable and make sure the music drive remains connected.
- Keep Windows awake for long Night searches; do not disconnect the large SQLite database in the middle of a scan.
- Do not run two program instances writing to the same music folder at once.
- Back up your audio collection and your personal Greek aliases or profile file before bulk housekeeping.

21 Getting lyrics onto your music player or car stereo

If the player supports synchronized LRC files, no separate conversion step is usually necessary: copy the audio file and matching .lrc sidecar together.

01 **Check the filename**

For **Example Song.mp3**, make sure the lyric file is **Example Song.lrc**. Different stems will not be paired by many devices.

02 **Check the folder**

Keep the song and LRC in the same directory when copying them to USB or another storage medium.

03 **Test one known-good track**

Try one file with clearly synchronized timestamps. Confirm that the player actually supports LRC and that the text encoding is accepted.

04 **Inspect candidates first**

Do not expect the car radio to see **.candidate.lrc** as normal lyrics. That suffix means the file has not been installed as a normal .lrc sidecar.

05 **Only then copy a larger folder**

If the test song works, move the larger selected music collection and its paired lyrics. The application does not change your audio file format.

> **Player differences**
>
> Car stereos vary: some require UTF-8 LRC, simple line-based timestamps, special menus or USB filesystem choices. These details depend on your player model and are not controlled by the lyrics finder.

22 Troubleshooting

If a search does not behave as expected, use the specific case below before reinstalling or redownloading a large database.

Control Center will not open	Extract all ZIP contents. For Python, check Python 3.10+ and run Run_Diagnostics.cmd. For standalone, keep both EXEs in the same folder.
Missing worker EXE	The standalone GUI needs LRC_Bulk_Finder_Worker.exe beside it. Re-extract the official complete standalone ZIP.
Python package error	Run OPEN_CONTROL_CENTER.cmd while online. Check that pip installed mutagen, Unidecode and syncedlyrics into the interpreter being launched.
Local DB not configured	For action 4/5, select the extracted .sqlite3 with Choose database or connect using the CMD tool. Action 1 can work without the large database.
LRCLIB download fails	Check drive space (installer minimum 350 GiB), stable internet and the official dump listing. Reuse an existing valid .sqlite3 whenever possible.
No matches / too many candidates	Verify artist/title metadata, song version and duration. Try FULL providers; review candidate reasons and provider error logs.
Nothing happens after Greek preview	Check Search after Greek preview. If disabled, the program stops after preview intentionally.
STOP does not seem finished	Check worker process status in the GUI and Windows Task Manager. Do not start a second scan on the same folder until the previous worker ends.
Candidate cannot be promoted	Only the primary .candidate.lrc with exactly one matching audio file and no existing .lrc can be promoted from the GUI.
Some songs are skipped	Look for LRC_Skipped.txt (missing metadata), existing .lrc files, LIVE names/tags and same-stem collisions.
Time estimate changes	ETA applies only to the active round; remote providers and recovery waits may change throughput dramatically.
SmartScreen warns	EXEs are unsigned. Verify official source/hash and antivirus status; do not disable Windows security globally.

Run diagnostics (Python edition)

In the extracted Python package, double-click **Run_Diagnostics.cmd**. It writes **Startup_Diagnostics.txt** in the application folder. Use it to identify Python/package errors. Do not publish private full music paths or inventories to a public GitHub issue without reviewing the log first.

When to consult the reports

Open **LRC_Timeouts.txt** to distinguish incomplete network attempts from **LRC_Not_Found.txt**; check **LRC_Review_Needed.txt** for candidate-bearing songs. Inspect detailed provider and HTTP CSV reports if several sources appear unavailable.

23 Safety, backups and where settings are stored

What the program changes

Original audio and ID3/tags	Read only. Not retagged, transcoded, renamed or overwritten.
Existing Song.lrc	Protected; not overwritten automatically.
Candidate files	Created separately as .candidate.lrc and numbered alternatives; explicit promotion required.
Profiles	Saved locally to Windows user settings.
Local LRCLIB database	Opened read-only for searches; not re-downloaded if reused.
Reports and checkpoints	Written to the selected music folder; can be archived locally.

Useful paths

```
%APPDATA%\LRCBulkFinder\profiles.json
<Music folder>\LRC_Incremental_Library_v2_4.sqlite3
<Music folder>\LRC_Run_Checkpoint_v2_4_3.jsonl
<Music folder>\LRC_Run_Reports\Run_..._v2_4_3
<Application folder>\LRCLIB_LOCAL_DB.txt
```

The program’s versioned report filenames may not all use 2.4.3. That is intentional for compatibility with existing report formats. Your profiles, edited dictionaries, checkpoints and large database are worth retaining when you unpack another program ZIP into a separate directory.

> **Suggested backup habit**
>
> Before cleaning folders or moving to a different PC, back up your music collection, its .lrc and .candidate files, any custom Greek dictionaries, the saved profiles.json and the path to your large local SQLite database. Do not delete the database because a new program ZIP has been released.

24 Frequently asked questions

Do I have to download a 250 GB database?

No. The program can perform normal searches online using action **1**. A local LRCLIB snapshot is required only if you want action **4** (strictly offline) or action **5** (whole-folder offline-first pipeline). Snapshot sizes vary.

Is Greek mode the same as Greek-only filtering?

No. It adds Greek/Greeklish search alternatives. It does not automatically exclude songs in other languages.

Does FULL mean that all songs will be found?

No. FULL enables up to twelve provider routes. Services overlap, can be offline, and may not contain synchronized lyrics for your recording. Strict identity checks can also send imperfect results to Candidate review.

Does the app edit my MP3 metadata?

No. It reads metadata; it creates separate sidecar files and reports.

Is a candidate safe to use?

It is safe in the sense that it is stored separately, but its content may be wrong. Listen and review before promotion; a promoted candidate remains marked unverified.

Does Night Search start itself at night?

No. It is an editable profile for long unattended searching, not a task scheduler.

Can I stop and restart later?

Yes. STOP terminates the worker, leaves the GUI open and keeps completed durable checkpoint entries. The song being processed and final reports can be incomplete; rerun the same saved profile.

Why do some reports say v2.1.15 while the program is v2.4.3?

The core retains some compatible report filenames from earlier formats. The executable and GUI identify themselves as v2.4.3.

25 Quick-reference checklist

Use this one-page checklist whenever you set up another computer or music folder.

Before a search

- ☐ The complete v2.4.3 ZIP has been extracted.
- ☐ The Control Center opens and the standalone worker is present if using the EXE edition.
- ☐ The music folder is correct, and Include subfolders is set as desired.
- ☐ For action 4 or 5, the large LRCLIB .sqlite3 file is correctly selected.
- ☐ Greek mode and optional G2G AI settings match your library and installed edition.
- ☐ Song limit is 20 for the first test; A only after a successful trial.
- ☐ Provider mode and order are intentional (FULL / DEFAULT are reasonable first choices).
- ☐ There is no second search process using the same music folder.

After a search

- ☐ Check Song.lrc next to Song.mp3 or the corresponding supported audio format.
- ☐ Open Candidate review for uncertain .candidate.lrc alternatives.
- ☐ Check LRC_Not_Found.txt, LRC_Skipped.txt and LRC_Timeouts.txt separately.
- ☐ Keep the computer awake during long unattended searches.
- ☐ Back up personalized profiles and Greek alias corrections.

Official resources

Latest version documented here: 2.4.3
Repository: github.com/DimitrisLai/LRC-Bulk-Finder
Release downloads: v2.4.3 release page
Python: python.org/downloads
LRCLIB database listing: lrclib.net/db-dumps

> **Final reminder**
>
> The goal is **correct synchronized lyrics**, not the highest possible number of automatic matches. A well-marked candidate is better than silently installing lyrics from the wrong song version.

Manual scope: LRC Bulk Finder v2.4.3 on Windows. Compiled from the v2.4.3 source code, package launchers, GUI controls and bundled instructions. External provider availability, Windows security prompts, disk sizes and device-specific LRC support can change.

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